

File

A file is a container in computer storage devices used for storing the data.

Files are needed because of the following:-

- ① The even if the program terminates the data is preserved in the file.
- ② The contents of the file can be accessed easily using few commands in C.
- ③ The data can be easily moved from one computer to another w/o any changes.

Types of files

① Text files

- These are .txt files.
- These can be created easily using simple text editors such as notepad.
- The contents can be easily edited and deleted.
- Take minimum effort to maintain, are easily readable & provide least security & takes bigger space.
- Data is stored in plain text.

② Binary files

- These are .bin files.
- Data is stored in binary form.
- They hold a higher amount of data, are not readable easily & provide better security.

Different types of Access in a file :

- ① Sequential Access
- ② Random Access

Sequential Access to a data file

- It means that computer system reads or writes info. to the file sequentially starting from the beginning of the file and proceeding step by step.
- It is faster than random access.
- It has advantages when the info. is accessed in the same order all the time.

Random Access to data file

- It means that the comp. system can read or write info. anywhere in the data file.
- Here the system knows where data is stored and hence goes directly & reads the data.
- It is ~~less faster~~ slower than sequential access.